J. ROBERT MANUEL

Music Educator · Choral Director · Organ & Keyboard Teacher

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Technical Interview Resume — Teaching — Music Education

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

A natural-born teacher of anything to anyone. Adjunct Music Faculty at Geneva College (9/2010–6/2011), Graduate Teaching Assistant at the University of Miami, and Illinois K–12 teaching certification (Music Education, with Special Education and music therapy) through Northwestern University — plus decades of mentoring choir singers and worship leaders.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Geneva College — Beaver Falls, PA **9/2010 – 6/2011**

Adjunct Music Faculty

- Taught freshman and sophomore core curriculum — individual (solo) ear training and music theory — the year-long core for future music teachers.
- Taught organ, including organ student Daniel Favand, on the pipe organ in an approximately 300-seat classroom built like a performance stage.
- Led a standing-room-only keyboard class on nine full-size keyboards in the basement of the college's old Victorian music house.
- Student-centered method: students brought two pieces they wanted to learn, then chose one work from the approved list for a recital jury of three music department chairs and the piano chair. Every student who remained in the course earned an A.

University of Miami — Coral Gables, FL **1988 – 1990**

Graduate Teaching Assistant (full teaching assistantship)

- Taught choir, private piano, and classroom music theory to freshman and sophomore classes while completing the Master of Music in Choral Conducting.

St. Stephen's Episcopal Church — Sewickley, PA **1993 – 2009**

Director of Music Ministries (full-time), 1994 – 2009 · Assistant Organist (part-time), 1993 – 1994

- Ran a large, full-range music program for a large Episcopal parish, managing more than 50 people weekly; the rector made the music post full-time in 1994.
- Directed the choral program and served as principal organist and pianist for the full liturgical year under the Book of Common Prayer (1979).
- Served during the parish's growth era under John Guest; built repertoire combining the organ and choral canon with contemporary and crossover styles.

Impact Christian Church — Moon Township, PA **Current**

Worship Team Musician (keyboard and vocals) · Worship-Leader Mentor

- Play and sing on the worship team, bringing organ, piano, and contemporary-worship experience to a modern worship setting.
- Mentor emerging worship leaders in musical preparation, flow, and pastoral sensitivity.

TEACHING & MENTORING

- **Church music mentoring:** from the men-and-boys choir legacy to the development of adult worship leaders.
- **SQA mentoring:** mentored developer and SQA teams in FDA-regulated environments and led start-up QA teams.

- **Drawing:** "two pages a day" teach-back practice in the Rodgon character-drawing method, building teach-from lesson packs.

EDUCATION & TEACHER CERTIFICATION

Northwestern University — Evanston, IL **1984 – 1988**
Bachelor of Music Education — student-teaching placements in three public school districts near Evanston

University of Miami — Coral Gables, FL **1996**
Master of Music, Choral Conducting — Full Teaching Assistantship (coursework 1988–1990; thesis and degree 1996)

Certification

- Illinois K–12 Teaching Certification (Music Education, with Special Education and music therapy) — Northwestern University.

CORE COMPETENCIES — MUSIC & TEACHING

Music, Worship & Teaching

- Pipe organ and piano performance; choir direction for adult, men-and-boys, and university choirs; SATB rehearsal technique
- Liturgical music direction in the Episcopal tradition (Book of Common Prayer 1979); contemporary worship-team leadership
- Sacred choral composition and engraving (SATB and organ); arranging and program-building for touring ensembles
- Collegiate teaching: ear training, music theory, organ studio, group keyboard; mentoring of worship leaders and young musicians

MUSICAL FORMATION

Formation and early training

- Countertenor in the Episcopal men-and-boys choir in Southport, Connecticut, under Ben Hawks.
- Organ study with Mrs. Larson, Dan Hursey, and Thomas Crawford, with study links to David Craighead; chamber Bach with Igor Kipnis in Greenwich, Connecticut, programs.
- Organ study at Northwestern University with Grigg Fountain and my primary organ instructor, Richard Enright.

EARLY INSTRUCTION

Public Beach, Oyster Road area — Fairfield, CT **Early career**
Lifeguard and Full-Time Sailing Director

REFERENCES

Professional and musical references are available on request.